

Reading

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Schools Around the World

Before you read

- Look at the title. What different types of schools can you think of?
- Guess: which type of school do you think most children in the world attend?

All over the world, children go to many different types of schools. In most countries, primary and secondary education is provided by the state, so state schools are attended by the majority of students. Tuition fees aren't usually charged, because state education is paid for by the government.

In some countries, private schools are also popular. Higher fees are paid by families for smaller classes, extra subjects, or special facilities like a swimming pool or a theatre. A different curriculum is sometimes followed by private schools, although the basic subjects are similar to those in state schools.

Boarding schools are another option. Students live at a boarding school during the term, and their daily routine — meals, homework and free time — is organised by the school itself. Boarding schools are chosen by some families because they are far from a good local school, or because they want their child to become more independent.

Not every student studies in a traditional classroom. Practical skills for a future job, like cooking, mechanics or nursing, are taught at vocational schools. A small number of families choose homeschooling instead, where children are taught at home, often by a parent, and lessons are planned around the family's own timetable.

Whichever type of school is chosen, the goal is the same everywhere: to help young people learn, grow and prepare for their future.

1. What is the text mainly about?

- a. Why school uniforms are important
- b. Different types of schools around the world
- c. How to become a teacher

2. Who usually pays for state education?

- a. Families
- b. The government
- c. Private companies

3. According to the text, why do some families choose a boarding school?

- a. Because it is free
- b. Because it is close to home
- c. Because it is far from a good school, or to build independence

4. What kind of skills are taught at vocational schools?

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- a. Practical skills for a future job
 - b. Only academic theory
 - c. Foreign languages only

5. In homeschooling, who often teaches the children?

- a. A professional tutor only
- b. Often a parent
- c. Nobody

6. According to the text, private schools always follow a completely different curriculum from state schools. — True / False

After you read

- Which type of school would you choose for yourself? Why?
- Compare your own school with one type of school from the text. Find one similarity and one difference.

Clubs, Competitions and Confidence

Before you read

- What extracurricular activities does your school offer?
- Guess: how can joining a club help a student who feels anxious?

Extracurricular activities are offered by almost every school, from sports teams to the debate team, drama club and music groups. These activities aren't just for fun — they help students develop new skills and make friends outside the classroom.

Last year, our school's drama club decided to compete in a regional festival. Auditions were held in October, and roles were given to students with different levels of experience. Even students who had never acted before were encouraged to join.

For many students, joining a new club can feel a little scary. Deniz, a Year 11 student, admits that she felt anxious before her first rehearsal. 'I was worried I wasn't talented enough,' she says. 'But the other students were really supportive, and I was reassured by our drama teacher.'

Feeling overwhelmed before a performance is completely normal. Experts say that a strong support system — friends, teachers and family — helps students cope with this kind of stress. Talking about your feelings, instead of hiding them, usually makes the nerves easier to manage.

By the night of the show, Deniz's nerves were forgotten. 'Once the curtain went up,' she laughs, 'I just enjoyed every minute.' Her story shows that a little courage — and the right support — can turn an anxious beginner into a confident performer.

1. What is the text mainly about?

- a. A new school building
- b. A student's experience of joining the drama club
- c. A list of school rules

2. When were the auditions held?

- a. In October
- b. In December
- c. At the end of the school year

3. How did Deniz feel before her first rehearsal?

- a. Bored
- b. Anxious
- c. Confident

4. What helped Deniz cope with her nerves, according to the text?

- a. Working alone
- b. Support from other students and her teacher
- c. Quitting the club

5. According to the text, what usually makes nerves easier to manage?

- a. Ignoring your feelings
- b. Talking about your feelings
- c. Avoiding the activity

6. Deniz felt nervous during the whole performance, from beginning to end. — *True / False*

After you read

- Have you ever felt nervous before trying something new at school? What helped you?
- Write two sentences of advice for a classmate who feels anxious about performing.